

Getting to the right problem using De-constrain



Specify your current problem



How can school project meetings be more efficient?



Identify your inherent beliefs

#1 All members must attend every meeting

#2 A meeting must cover every topic

#3 Everyone stays focused, however long the meeting runs



Challenge these beliefs

#1 Only people related to or needed for the topic attend

#2 Cover only the predefined agenda; speakers keep to time

#3 Keep meetings short, before people lose focus and get exhausted



Re-align your problem



How can we implement shorter meetings with a predefined agenda that involves the right team members for future school project meetings?

Breakout Group Practice

Creative Matrix

Group work | 10 mins

Group share back | 5 mins

Problem
Statement

How can we implement shorter meetings with predefined agenda that involves the right team members for future school project meetings?

Enabler #1
Devices + Technology

Google Docs agenda
template sent 24 hrs
before

WhatsApp poll to confirm
who attends

Simplified slides prepared
with AI

Enabler #2
Programs + Principles

Rule: "No agenda, no
meeting"

Rotating timekeeper with
a 15-min cap

Only task owners attend;
others get the notes

Enabler #3
Events + Experiences

10-min stand-up check-ins

Present updates using the
7Cs

Weekly written update
instead of one meeting

Parking Lot

Monthly review of meetings to
spot what's wasting time

Peer rating of meeting
participation

Options Assessment Matrix

- 1) Determine evaluation criteria
- 2) Weight criteria
- 3) Describe consequences
- 4) Calculate total score
- 5) Articulate trade-offs

Criterion	Weights	Idea 1: Agenda template	Idea 2: Timekeeper + 15-min cap	Idea 3: Task owners only
A · Shortens meetings	30%	2	3	2
B · Easy to implement	25%	3	3	2
C · Low cost	10%	3	3	3
D · Team buy-in	20%	2	2	1
E · Involves the right members	15%	2	1	3
Total score:	100%	2.35	2.50	2.05

Recommendation: Idea 2 (2.50), a rotating timekeeper with a 15-min cap, because it shortens meetings most and is easy to start. Trade-off: it's weakest on involving the right members, so we combine it with Idea 1's agenda template, which lists who needs to attend.